

# 2024 JavaScript Rising Stars: The Year's Hottest Projects by GitHub Stars

9th Edition Analysis of GitHub Stars Added in 2024



Methodology: Based on GitHub stars added over the last 12 months for projects curated by Best of JS.



# shadcn/ui Leads Overall with +38k Stars, Followed by Ex

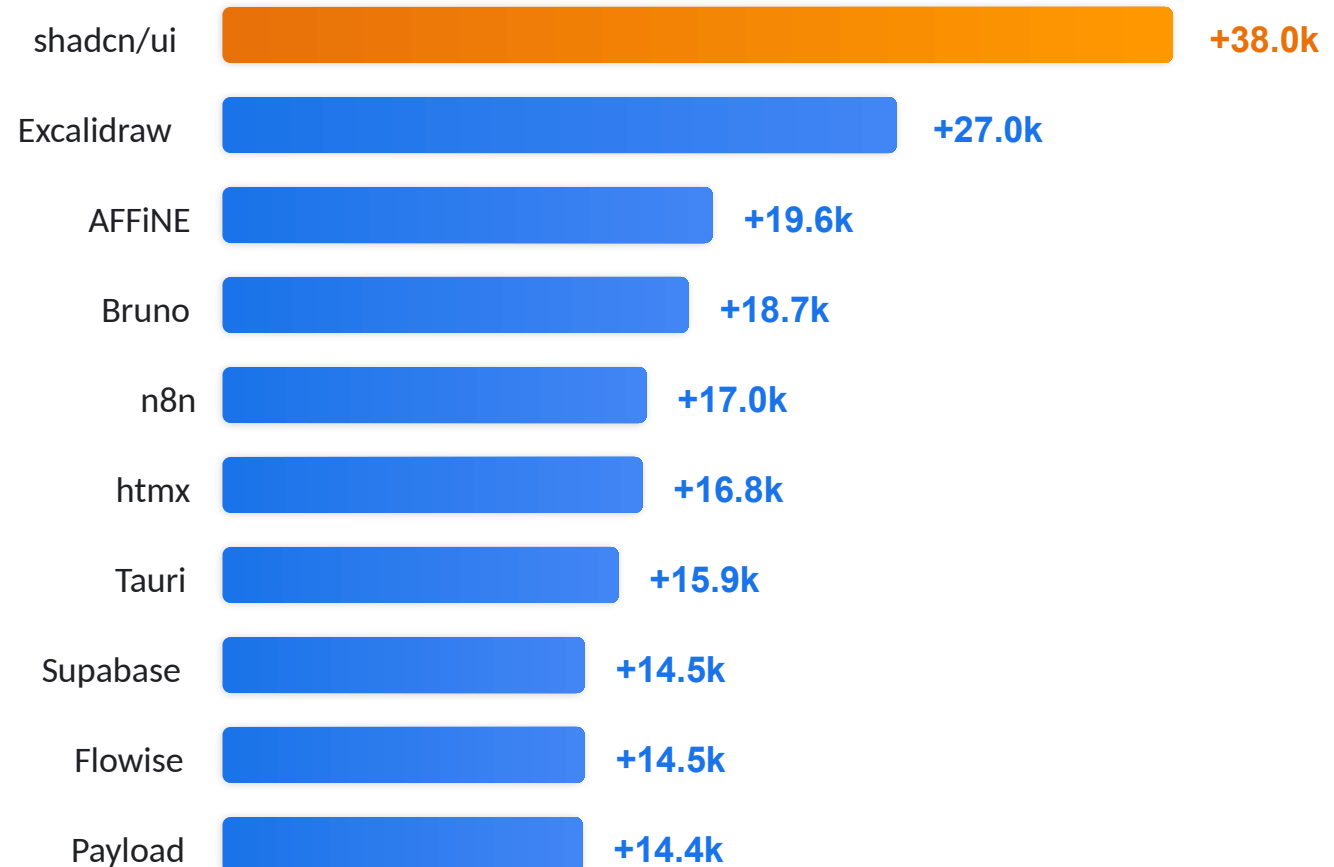
## Massive Gap at the Top

shadcn/ui added an astounding 38.0k stars, creating an 11k star gap between #1 and #2.

## Notable High-Fliers

- ★ Excalidraw (+27k)
- ★ AFFiNE (+19.6k)
- ★ Bruno (+18.7k)
- ★ n8n (+17.0k)

### Top 10 Most Popular Projects Overall (2024 Stars Added)



# shadcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win for the Second

## Sustained Momentum

39.5k in 2023, 38.0k in 2024. Reached 77.5k total (Push

## Key 2024 Features

Charts (Bar charts), Themes, Blocks, Sidebars

## Upgraded CLI

Supports Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel.  
Multi-framework ecosystem integration.

By year



Trends in 2024



# htmx Overtakes React as #1 Front-end Framework by Stars

## HTML-first is Serious

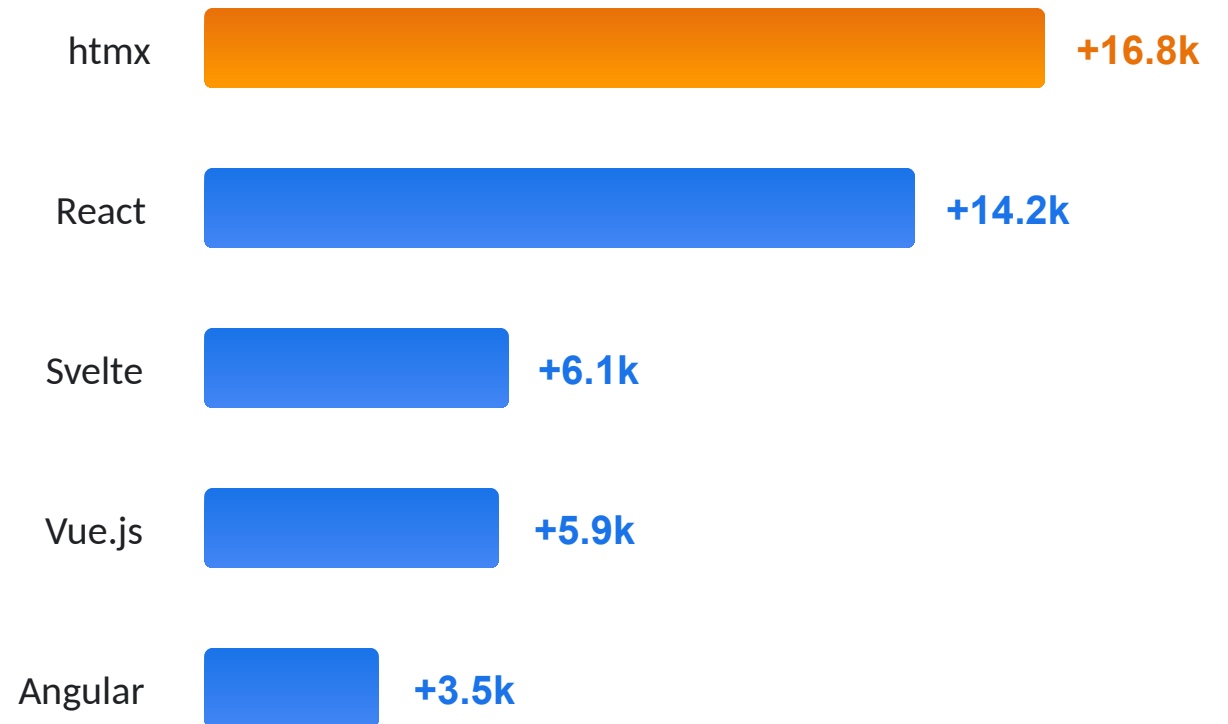
htmx philosophy validates server-driven architectures. It extends HTML with hx-\* attributes to enable interactivity without writing JS.

## React's Evolution

React 19 brings Server Components and Server Functions.

React is becoming a "specification for frameworks" with multiple ecosystem implementations.

Top 5 Front-end Frameworks (2024 Stars Added)



# React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload Do

## A Full-Stack Specification

React's shift toward a full-stack framework specification means multiple frameworks interpret React's primitives differently.

## Diverse Innovations

From UI components (shadcn/ui, Magic UI) to full-stack backend solutions (Payload) and complex applications (Excalidraw).

### Top 5 React Ecosystem Projects



shadcn/ui

+38.0k



Excalidraw

+27.0k



Payload

+14.4k



Magic UI

+13.2k



Next.js

+12.1k



# Vue Ecosystem Flourishes: Nuxt, PrimeVue, and Slidev L

## Ecosystem Maturity

Vue ecosystem maturity is validated by a wave of high-quality UI libraries (PrimeVue, shadcn-vue).

## Reactivity Rework

Vue 3.5 introduced a reactivity rework, utilizing the lighter alien-signals approach.

### Top 5 Vue Ecosystem Projects



Nuxt

+6.2k



PrimeVue

+5.4k



Slidev

+4.7k



shadcn-vue

+4.1k



VitePress

+3.7k



# AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser-Based Innovation S



## AI Integration

- **n8n (+17.0k)**  
Workflow automation with native AI capabilities.
- **Flowise (+14.5k)**  
Visual LLM flow building.
- **Supabase (+14.5k)**  
Open-source BaaS backend embracing AI capabilities.



## Desktop Apps

- **Tauri (+15.9k)**  
Continues the push for lighter desktop and mobile apps built with web technologies.
- **Cross-Platform Trend**  
Developers demand efficient alternatives to Electron.



## Browser Capabilities

- **PGLite**  
Postgres running natively in the browser via WebAssembly.
- **WebVM**  
A complete virtual machine running entirely client-side.
- **Shift to Edge**  
Moving complex compute from server to browser.

# Key Takeaways: What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

1

**Component ownership beats imports:**shadcn/ui proves the copy-paste model works.

2

**HTML-first approaches gain serious traction:**htmx taking the #1 framework spot validate

3

**React is becoming a framework specification:**It is no longer just a standalone library.

4

**AI integration is now table stakes:**Top projects naturally integrate or serve AI capabilities.

5

**Vue's UI library ecosystem is a sign of maturity:**Confidence is growing in Vue's trajectory.

